Sikh Warriors (Painting by Smyth, courtesy Imperial Hotel, New Delhi).

I have derived my inspiration and pride as a soldier from the exemplary leadership and saga of sacrifice of our gurus, warriors and military leaders such as Guru Gobind Singh, Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj, Maharaja Ranjit Singh, Rana Sangha and generals like Hari Singh Nalwa, Lachit Borphukan, Tipu Sultan and Zorawar Singh.

I imbibed certain values as part of growing up. I don't profess to have a profound knowledge of Sikhism, but I sincerely endeavour to be a good Sikh in my own way. My god has never failed me and has answered my prayers. At the same time, I have always cheerfully accepted whatever has happened in my life as my destiny. But most importantly, faith and religion for me are issues that are very personal. All through my career these did not have any place in my professional life, and have been an intensely private matter for our family. The spiritual strength derived from my faith has given me the confidence to stand on my feet and face the ups and downs of life.

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[1] Rebaab is a traditional stringed musical instrument. Mardana, the closest disciple of Guru Nanak, was always seen with it.

[2] *Japjee: The Sikh Morning Prayer*, Himalayan Books, p. 34.

[3] Khushwant Singh, *A History of the Sikhs*, Vol. I, Oxford University Press, p. 35.

[4] Patwant Singh, *The Sikhs*, Rupa & Co, p. 36.

[5] Ibid., p. 72.

[6] Ibid., p. 133.

[7] Philip Mason, *A Matter of Honour*, EBD Educational Private Limited, Dehradun, p. 367.